

Board: 1

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 9 8
 ♥ A 5
 ♦ Q 10 6 2
 ♣ Q 4 3

♠ K 7 5 3
 ♥ Q 8 6 4
 ♦ A K 7
 ♣ J 2



♠ A 6 2
 ♥ J 10 3
 ♦ 8 5 4
 ♣ A K 8 5

♠ 10 4
 ♥ K 9 7 2
 ♦ J 9 3
 ♣ 10 9 7 6

West	North	East	South
Pass	1♦	Pass	2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North
 the ♥7.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♥2, West wins the ♥A and returns the ♥5. East takes the ♥K and plays the ♥7.

Winner count: ♠ 2 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 2 : Total = 8

You are glad the defense started with ♥s, that was a suit you would have had to play yourself. You need one more winner and your first thought may be that the ♠s are going to have to split 3-3. However, that happens only about 40% of the time so you keep looking. There is one more card that might be valuable, the ♣J. If West holds the ♣Q then you can make a trick out of the ♣J.

You are already in dummy with the ♥J so you lead a small ♣. If West plays low you will play the ♣J which will hold the trick and become your 9th winner. If West plays his ♣Q you will have the ♣J for your 9th winner later.

And if West doesn't have the ♣Q at all? then you **STILL** have the possibility of a 3-3 ♠ split.

As you see, this time the ♠s didn't split so you had to make the ♣J to succeed.

You have 13 points so you will definitely open the bidding. You don't open with a 4-card Major and you don't open with a 2-card ♣ suit. So this is the one distribution where you open a 3-card ♦ suit. Partner responds 2♣ and

Be very careful! You are tempted to now bid 2♥ or 2♠. Don't give in to the temptation. That would be a **REVERSE** - bidding a second, higher-ranking suit at the 2-level. You should have at least 16 points to reverse. Besides, if you trust partner you don't need to bid either of those suits anyway. If he had a 4-card Major he probably would have shown it on his first bid. No, your next bid is clearly 2NT. Partner raises to 3NT and you pass.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♥2, West wins the ♥A and returns the ♥5. East takes the ♥K and plays

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q J 10 8 2

♥ 9 6 5

♦ Q 10

♣ Q 7 4

♠ K 7

♥ J 7 4

♦ A 7 5 3

♣ J 9 8 5



♠ A 9 6 5 4 3

♥ 8 2

♦ K J 8

♣ A K

♠ -

♥ A K Q 10 3

♦ 9 6 4 2

♣ 10 6 3 2

West	North	East	South
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Pass	Pass	1 ♠	2 ♥
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4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

But he didn't open, so he doesn't have the ♠ K.

You open 1 ♠. South overcalls 2 ♥ and partner bids 4 ♠.

East plays 4 ♠. South leads ♥ A, ♥ K, ♥ Q.

East plays 4 ♠. South leads ♥ A, ♥ K, ♥ Q.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 0 : Total = 4

You have already lost the 2 ♥s and you will definitely lose the ♦. So you cannot lose a ♠ as well. When you have 11 cards in a suit missing the King, the recommended play is to play for the drop. But the recommended play shouldn't be used on this hand because you know that North has the ♠ K. How do you know this? Because South has turned up with 10 points in ♥s, (the A K Q and a fifth one). If he held the ♠ K as well he would have had 13 points and a good suit and would have opened he bidding.

Ruff the ♥. Play the ♦ 8 to dummy's ♦ 10. If North takes the ♦ A win his return and enter dummy with the ♦ Q. When in dummy lead the ♠ Q and finesse North out of his ♠ K.

You have to listen to the bidding and draw conclusions from what is bid - and not bid. Because he passed originally you could figure out that South could not hold the ♠ K. Or, if you had needed to know, he could also not have had the ♦ A.